

30 Minutes Expert

Connect sans Net

Have you ever wanted to copy a song or a game from a friend, but found it too small to burn on a CD and too large to waste floppies on, so ultimately downloaded it from the Net? Or have you needed to work from home and the only way to synchronise your work with your office PC was via e-mail? Here's a way to share files across PCs without an Internet connection. All you need is a modem connected to a phone line on each PC and they can be connected directly to each other.

 You can set up Windows 98 to receive incoming dial-up connections by setting up Dial-Up Server on one



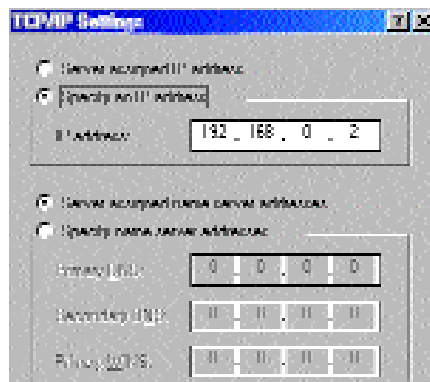
Enable Dial-Up Server to receive incoming modem connections

PC and Dial-Up Networking on the other. Open **Control Panel > Add/Remove Programs > Windows Setup**. Select Communications and click Details. Check the box next to Dial-Up Server and click OK. You will need the Windows 98 installation CD for the files to be copied. Once installed, you can configure the machine for incoming connections from **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications > Dial-Up Networking**. Here, open Dial-Up Server from the Communications menu and enable Allow Caller Access. You may assign a password by clicking the Change Password button.

 Next, you need to configure TCP/IP on both machines for them to be

able to communicate with each other. First, set the IP address on the server (the machine that will receive the calls). Open **Control Panel > Network**, select **TCP/IP > Dial-Up Adapter** and click Properties. Select 'Specify an IP address' and enter the IP address and Subnet mask. You can enter **192.168.0.1** as the IP address and **255.255.255.0** for the subnet. Note that you will need to reset it to 'Obtain an IP address automatically' if you want to make dial-up connections (for example, to your ISP) from this machine. On clicking OK, you will be asked to restart the machine.

 To set up the client machine, open Dial-Up Networking from **Start > Programs > Accessories > Communications**. Create a new connection with default settings, entering the phone number of the line connected to the server. Once the connection is created, right-click it and click Properties. Under the Server Types tab, disable 'Log on to network', click TCP/IP Settings and again select 'Specify an IP address'. Enter an IP address for this machine (e.g. **192.168.0.2**) and click OK. In this case the IP address has been specified only for this connection, so other dial-up



Configure TCP/IP settings on the Client

connections will work just fine without having to change any settings.

 To be able to share folders over a dial-up connection, you will need to have 'File and printer sharing' enabled.

RemotelyAnywhere 4.51.298

Find it in Software > Home
on the Mindware CD



Remote Control Software

These software let you connect to another machine over dial-up, LAN or similar connections and use it as if it were your PC. Some of the most popular software are Virtual Network Computing (www.uk.research.att.com/vnc), pcAnywhere (www.symantec.com), ControlIT (www.ca.com), Carbon Copy (www.altiris.com) and Remote Administrator (www.radmin.com).

This can be done from **Control Panel > Network**. Simply double-click the connection on the client and it will connect with the server. The machine should be visible from Network Neighborhood, but if you can't see it, you can browse the shared resource by using its IP address. For example, you can access a shared folder called 'share' on the server by typing **\\192.168.0.1\share** in the Windows Explorer address bar. Another way to access the machine is from **Start > Find > Computer**—again, you have to enter the IP address here.

 You can even set up remote desktop management software on the server and have complete control over it from the client. We will use a software called RemotelyAnywhere (www.remotelyanywhere.com)—this is completely TCP/IP based and works off a Web browser. When installing the software, you can configure which ports it should use for HTTP (for remote control), Telnet and SSH. You can leave all settings to default (HTTP is on port 2000). After connecting from the client machine, open up a Web browser and go to **http://192.168.0.1:2000/**. This will open up the RemotelyAnywhere screen from where you can manage all files, system settings and even control the remote desktop as if it were the local machine. 

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